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Second cycle, 30 credits

Patient-Specific Parameter Estimation in Mechanistic Insulin-Glucose Models

Degree Project 2026

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Master's Programme, Information and Network Engineering, 120 credits
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Abstract

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- Short problem statement
- Why was this problem worth a Bachelor's/Master's thesis project? (*i.e.*, why is the problem both significant and of a suitable degree of difficulty for a Bachelor's/Master's thesis project? Why has no one else solved it yet?)
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Text superscripts and subscripts with `\textsubscript` and `\textsuperscript`: A_x and A^x .

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$$\int_a^b x^2 dx$$

Note that you **cannot** use an equation between dollar signs.

Even LaTeX comments can be handled, for example: `% comment`. Note that one can include percentages, such as: 51% or 51 %.

Keywords

Canvas Learning Management System, Docker containers, Performance tuning

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If you are writing your thesis in English, then this section can be a summary targeted at a more general reader. However, if you are writing your thesis in Swedish, then the reverse is true – your abstract should be for your target audience, while an English summary can be written targeted at a more general audience.

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Nyckelord

Canvas Lärplattform, Dockerbehållare, Prestandajustering

Nyckelord som beskriver innehållet i uppsatsen eller rapporten

Acknowledgments

Författarnas tack

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En dualism som måste hanteras i hela rapporten och projektet

I would like to thank xxxx for having yyyy. Or in the case of two authors: We would like to thank xxxx for having yyyy.

Stockholm, April 2026

Markus Mulvihill

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Patients in the intensive care unit suffering from critical illnesses (e.g. acute myocardial infarction, sepsis, stroke) have been widely documented to undergo hyperglycaemia, even those without a prior diagnosis of diabetes [1]. Acute stress observed in critical illnesses often induces physiological changes, as the secretion of cortisol and catecholamines results in an inflammatory response associated with insulin-resistance [2] [3] [4] [5] [6] [7]. While there is inconclusive evidence pertaining to the causality of stress hyperglycaemia and adverse outcomes, the onset of mortality is far greater in patients with no reported history of hyperglycaemia, in contrast to patients with diabetes [1] [3]. Sustaining glucose concentration under 6.106 mmol/L through insulin infusion has demonstrated a reduction of mortality and morbidity, compared to less-intensive methods of glycaemic control [8], at the subsequent cost of an increase of reported incidences of hypoglycaemia [9]. Further review of intensive insulin therapy and tight glucose control has identified discrepancies in the administration of glycaemic control, mostly corresponding to the risk of moderate to severe hypoglycaemia and glycaemic variability in a critically ill patient is equally detrimental as stress hyperglycaemia, with an increase of mortality and health complications observed [9] [10] [11]. Clinicians aim to maintain blood glucose in a range of 6 mmol/L to 10 mmol/L to account for adverse outcomes in hyperglycaemia and hypoglycaemia. Traditional intensive insulin therapy struggles to fully capture the dynamic fluctuations of blood glucose in critically ill patients. Thus, more personalized model-based methods are required to achieve tight glycaemic control.

1.1 Background

The implementation of state feedback in model-based tight glucose control methods relies on the formulation of derived state estimators of insulin-glucose dynamics. Mechanistic insulin-glucose models have been developed with an extensive physiological foundation, and have been validated for gluco-regulation in clinical settings [12] [13] [14] [15] [16]. The insulin-glucose models derived are nonlinear, which requires more advanced state estimation methods to properly estimate the insulin-glucose dynamics in patients, as well as prediction into the future. The patient parameters used in such estimators must reflect glucose-insulin dynamics observed physiologically to accurately model gluco-regulation. Mechanistic insulin-glucose models published have traditionally assigned patient parameters as population constants, backed by parameter sensitivity analysis studies. There are data-driven methods to approximate some patient parameters as shown in [14] [16], but a lack of estimators for a subset of patient-specific parameters has been implemented along with the nonlinear state estimation of insulin-glucose dynamics. As a result, this current methodology of estimating insulin-glucose dynamics is not designed to be patient-specific.

1.2 Problem

1.2.1 Original problem and definition

There currently exists a gap in research for further fine-tuning of mechanistic insulin-glucose models. While there is evidence shown in sensitivity studies that certain patient-specific parameters do not have much influence in the insulin-glucose dynamics [12] [15] [16], inadequate assigning of the remaining parameters can lead to inadequate glycaemic control in critically ill patients.

1.2.2 Scientific and engineering issues

System identification can be employed to model the behavior of dynamical systems. Experience of statistical modeling within system identification is often required to construct the assumptions of the system parameters. In the case of insulin-glucose dynamics, there are several unknown patient-specific parameters, and each has its respective role in modeling gluco-regulation. As

a result, identifying key patient-specific parameters and the methods to model them are not intuitive, and poses an ongoing challenge.

1.3 Purpose

Mechanistic insulin-glucose models are of great benefit to critically ill patients and clinicians, as modeling gluco-regulation allows for necessary glycaemic adjustments to avoid the onset of adverse outcomes. In practice, clinicians only have the ability to base insulin sensitivity on blood glucose measurements, and thus, state estimators models fill in the gap as a tool for insulin-glucose dynamics estimation. Improvements in the estimation of insulin-glucose dynamics can better capture the evolution of the health of the patient in the intensive care unit to prevent mortality and morbidity.

1.4 Goals

The overall goal of this project is the estimation of patient-specific parameters in mechanistic insulin-glucose models to compare to current methods. This has been divided into the following sub-goals:

1. Estimate insulin-glucose dynamics using a nonlinear state estimator
2. Determine the subset of patient-specific parameters of interest to model
3. Formulate and evaluate estimators for chosen patient-specific parameters

1.5 Research Methodology

The modeling of the insulin-glucose dynamics found in critically ill patients will be implemented on a virtual patient cohort. Using virtual patients allows the researcher to manually control the patient-specific parameters. The control of the experiment will be insulin-glucose state estimators without any parameter estimation (i.e. assigning parameters as population constants), while the treatment group incorporates parameter estimation with the state estimators. To evaluate the performance of the study, the control group and the treatment group will estimate the insulin-glucose dynamics of unseen virtual patients, and fitting metrics of the state estimators are utilized to draw inferences about the performance of the parameter estimation.

1.6 Delimitations

This study will not consist of any real patient data from the intensive care unit. Using virtual patients is important for maintaining internal validity in the experimental process, as it verifies the observed outcome of the experiment is due to the manipulation of patient-specific parameters and not from uncontrolled variables. This study will build the foundation of the modeling of insulin-glucose dynamics, and future work can replicate the study with preprocessed real patient data.

1.7 Structure of the thesis

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Chapter 2

Background

The Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose model presented by Lin et al. [14] characterizes the insulin-glucose dynamics in critically ill patients. The model is constructed as a fusion of two existing models validated for patients in the intensive care unit [12] [13], containing the following ensemble of ordinary differential equations

$$\dot{G} = -p_G G(t) - S_I(t) G(t) \frac{Q(t)}{1 + \alpha_G Q(t)} + \frac{P(t) + E_G - C_G}{V_G} \quad (2.1)$$

$$\dot{Q} = n_I(I(t) - Q(t)) - n_C \frac{Q(t)}{1 + \alpha_G Q(t)} \quad (2.2)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{I} = & -n_K I(t) - n_L \frac{I(t)}{1 + \alpha_I I(t)} - n_I(I(t) - Q(t)) + \frac{u_{ex}(t)}{V_I} \\ & + \frac{(1 - x_L)u_{en}(t)}{V_I} \end{aligned} \quad (2.3)$$

$$\dot{P1} = -d_1 P1 + D(t) \quad (2.4)$$

$$\dot{P2} = -\min(d_2 P2, P_{max}) + d_1 P1 \quad (2.5)$$

$$P(t) = -\min(d_2 P2, P_{max}) + P_N(t) \quad (2.6)$$

$$u_{en}(t) = k_1 e^{-\frac{k_2}{k_3} I(t)}, \quad \text{when C-peptide data is not available.} \quad (2.7)$$

Equation (2.1) is the independent insulin glucose removal, with G being the total blood glucose concentration (mmol/L). The whole-body insulin sensitivity $S_I(t)$ gives insight into the metabolic condition of the patient and is a time-varying dynamic. The insulin pharmacodynamics are shown in Equations (2.2) and (2.3), with Q and I being the interstitial insulin concentration (mU/L) and the plasma insulin concentration (mU/L)

respectively. The exogenous insulin input is $u_{ex}(t)$ (mU/min), and the endogenous insulin production $u_{en}(t)$ (mU/min) can be measured from C-Peptide, but if measurements are not feasible, the kinetics can model as such in Equation (2.7). The gastric absorption of glucose is defined in Equations (2.4) to (2.6). The dynamics $P1$ and $P2$ describe the glucose in the stomach and the gut (mmol), with $P(t)$ representing the glucose appearance in the blood (mmol/min). Any enteral food intake given to the patient is accounted for by $D(t)$ (mmol/min), and additional parenteral dextrose is described by $P_N(t)$ (mmol/min).

The Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose model consists of several fixed parameters detailed in Table 2.1. The majority of the patient model parameters are assigned as general population constants observed from clinical trials, and are validated in relevant insulin-glucose control parameter sensitivity studies [15] [16] [17]. The identification of the remaining constant parameters was estimated with a data-driven approach (i.e. model identifiability) by fitting the patient parameters to the observed dynamics in 173 patients, and by assessing the impact of prediction errors. Estimating the endogenous glucose removal p_G and the suppression of endogenous glucose produce E_G constants involved assigning all other patient parameters and the insulin sensitivity to constants, then starting a grid search that covers $p_G = 0.001, 0.002, \dots, 0.1(\text{min}^{-1})$ and $E_G = 0.0, 0.1, \dots, 3.5$ (mmol/min). The joint p_G and E_G value that achieved the lowest fitting and prediction error for blood glucose in Equation (2.1) was chosen. Ultimately, that was $p_G = 0.006(\text{min}^{-1})$ and $E_G = 1.16$, while both falling in the ranges observed physiologically. The glucose distribution rate between the stomach and the gut n_I , and cellular insulin clearance rate in the interstitium were estimated similarly by fitting to Q in the Equation (2.2), a grid search covers a range of $n_I = n_C = 0.0001, \dots, 0.02(\text{min}^{-1})$, with a value of $n_I = 0.003$ resulting in the best predictive performance.

While the proposed clinically-validated model for patients in the intensive care unit has shown to capture long-term insulin-glucose dynamics, in practice, typically it is only possible for clinicians to take blood glucose measurements, consequently, excluding measurements for the dynamics seen in Equations (2.2) to (2.5). Thus, leveraging estimators is a viable solution to account for the lack of intuition into the dynamics that can not be measured.

Table 2.1: Constant parameters in the Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose model.

Constant Parameter	Notation	Value
Patient endogenous glucose removal	p_G (min^{-1})	0.006
Saturation of insulin-stimulated glucose removal	α_G (L/mU)	0.0154
Suppression of endogenous glucose production	E_G (mmol/min)	1.16
Central nervous system uptake	C_G (mmol/L)	0.3
Glucose distribution volume	V_G (L)	13.3
Glucose distribution rate between the stomach and the gut	n_I (min^{-1})	0.003
Cellular insulin clearance rate in the interstitium	n_C (min^{-1})	$= n_I$
Kidney clearance rate of insulin from plasma	n_K (min^{-1})	0.0542
Liver clearance rate of insulin from plasma	n_L (min^{-1})	0.01578
Saturation of plasma insulin disappearance	α_I (L/mU)	0.0017
Insulin distribution volume	V_I (L)	3.15
Fraction of endogenous insulin hepatic extraction	x_L	0.67
Maximal glucose out flux from the gut	P_{max} (mmol/min)	6.11
Base endogenous insulin production rate	k_1 (mU/min)	45.7
Transport rates between the stomach and the gut	d_1 (min^{-1})	0.0347
	d_2 (min^{-1})	0.0069
Exponential suppression constants	k_2	1.5
	k_3	1000

Parameters shaded in gray are derived from fitting methods, as the rest are assigned as population constants.

2.1 State Estimation

A probabilistic state estimator can be modeled in the following state space representation

$$\begin{aligned} x_k &\sim p(x_k | x_{k-1}, u_{k-1}) \\ y_k &\sim p(y_k | x_k), \end{aligned} \quad (2.8)$$

where $p(x_k | x_{k-1}, u_k)$ and $p(y_k | x_k)$ are the discrete-time dynamic and measurement models, with $x_k \in \mathbb{R}^n$ representing the states, $u_k \in \mathbb{R}^p$ are the inputs, and $y_k \in \mathbb{R}^m$ are the measurements. The objective is to ultimately derive the distribution of the state x_k , given all the measurements up to the current sample $p(x_k | y_{1:k})$. In the case of assuming the state estimator is linear and Gaussian,

$$\begin{aligned} x_k &= A_{k-1}x_{k-1} + B_{k-1}u_{k-1} + q_{k-1} \\ y_k &= Hx_k + r_k, \end{aligned} \quad (2.9)$$

where $q_{k-1} \sim N(0, Q_{k-1})$ is the process noise, $r_k \sim N(0, R_k)$ is the measurement noise, we can rewrite the Equation (2.8) as the following

$$\begin{aligned} p(x_k | x_{k-1}, u_{k-1}) &= N(x_k | A_{k-1}x_{k-1} + B_{k-1}u_{k-1}, Q_{k-1}) \\ p(y_k | x_k) &= N(y_k | H_k x_k, R_k). \end{aligned} \quad (2.10)$$

The closed-form solution of $p(x_k | y_{1:k})$ for linear and Gaussian dynamic and measurement functions is known as the Kalman filter, with a full derivation available from Sräkkä and Svensson [18]. The filter contains two key parts: the *prediction step* and the *update step*.

1. Prediction step

$$\begin{aligned} m_k^- &= A_{k-1}x_{k-1} + B_{k-1}u_{k-1} \\ P_k^- &= A_{k-1}P_{k-1}A_{k-1}^T + Q_{k-1}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.11)$$

2. Update step

$$\begin{aligned} v_k &= y_k - H_k m_k^- \\ S_k &= H_k P_k^- H_k^T + R_k \\ K_k &= P_k^- H_k^T S_k^{-1} \\ m_k &= m_k^- + K_k v_k \\ P_k &= P_k^- - K_k S_k K_k^T. \end{aligned} \quad (2.12)$$

The Kalman filter is recursive, as the filter starts with an estimate of the initial distribution of the state m_0^- and the covariance P_0^- , and iterates sequentially over discrete time steps k . While the Kalman filter is a great starting point for an estimator, as the assumptions of linearity and Gaussianity often hold in many contexts, it is clear when analyzing the Equations (2.1) to (2.5), the ordinary differential equations are not linear, hence, the estimators of choice must have the capability to properly handle nonlinearities in the dynamic function.

2.1.1 Extended Kalman filter

The extended Kalman filter expands upon the linearity condition to allow for nonlinear models. The structure of the extended Kalman filter remains the same as the Equations (2.13) and (2.14), but changes are seen in the matrices of the dynamic and measurement models $f(\cdot)$ and $h(\cdot)$. Assuming the same Gaussianity condition as the Kalman filter, the prediction and update steps [18] can be defined as

1. Prediction step

$$\begin{aligned} m_k^- &= f(m_{k-1}, u_{k-1}) \\ P_k^- &= F_x(m_{k-1})P_{k-1}F_x^T(m_{k-1}) + Q_{k-1} \end{aligned} \quad (2.13)$$

2. Update step

$$\begin{aligned} v_k &= y_k - h(m_k^-) \\ S_k &= H_x(m_k^-)P_k^-H_x^T(m_k^-) + R_k \\ K_k &= P_k^-H_k^T(m_k^-)S_k^{-1} \\ m_k &= m_k^- + K_k v_K \\ P_k &= P_k^- - K_k S_k K_k^T, \end{aligned} \quad (2.14)$$

the Jacobian matrices $F_x(m_k^-)$ and $H_x(m_k^-)$ are derived from $f(\cdot)$ and $h(\cdot)$, as F_x and H_x are inferred from the Taylor series Gaussian approximation of a linear transformation, and are written as

$$\begin{aligned} [F_x(m)]_{j,j'} &= \left. \frac{\partial f_j(x)}{\partial x_{j'}} \right|_{x=m} \\ [H_x(m)]_{j,j'} &= \left. \frac{\partial h_j(x)}{\partial x_{j'}} \right|_{x=m}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.15)$$

2.1.2 Bootstrap particle filter

When revisiting the probabilistic state estimators in section 2.1, to analytically compute the point estimate of the states $\hat{x}$, given all observations up to time step K , one must evaluate the expected value of the conditional probability

$$\hat{x} = E[g(x) \mid y_{1:K}] = \sum_x g(x)p(x \mid y_{1:K}), \quad (2.16)$$

with $g(\cdot)$ being an arbitrary function $\mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$. Such an integral is often difficult to compute in closed-form due to the intractability of the posterior $p(x \mid y_{1:K})$ in many settings, but by formulating a Monte Carlo approximation by drawing N many random samples from the target distribution $x^{(i)} \sim p(x \mid y_{1:K})$ $i = 1, \dots, N$, the approximation of the point estimate of the states will converge to the true point estimate for a large N , according to the Law of Large Numbers and the Central Limit Theorem [19], and the approximation

of the point estimate of the states can be rewritten as

$$\hat{x} \approx \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N g(x^{(i)}) p(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K}). \quad (2.17)$$

The conditional probability $p(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K})$ can be rewritten in terms of the likelihood $p(y_{1:K} | x^{(i)})$ and the prior $p(x^{(i)})$ according to Bayes' rule

$$p(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K}) = \frac{p(y_{1:K} | x^{(i)}) p(x^{(i)})}{p(y_{1:K})}. \quad (2.18)$$

The normalization term is often not able to be computed numerically, but by introducing importance sampling, the term can be approximated. The importance mass $\pi(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K})$ is a Monte Carlo approximation of $p(y_{1:K})$, with the condition that the mass is non-zero whenever $p(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K})$ is non-zero, which results in a nonuniform distribution. Sampling from a nonuniform distribution will result in each particle having a corresponding weight $w^{*(i)}$, and a normalized weight w^i

$$\begin{aligned} w^{*(i)} &= \frac{p(y_{1:K} | x^{(i)}) p(x^{(i)})}{\pi(x^{(i)} | y_{1:K})} \\ w^i &= \frac{w^{*(i)}}{\sum_{j=1}^N w^{*(j)}}, \end{aligned} \quad (2.19)$$

with the approximation of the point estimate being rewritten as

$$\hat{x} \approx \sum_{i=1}^N w^i g(x^{(i)}). \quad (2.20)$$

The bootstrap particle filter is formulated on the basis of Markov Chain Monte Carlo approximations, the filtering distributions are shown in Equation (2.8), and the filter is run sequentially like the Kalman filter, the importance mass is assigned as the dynamic model $p(x_k | x_{k-1}^{(i)})$ at the time step k for a given particle (i) , which results in the following algorithm [18] [19]

1. Sample N particles from the dynamic function

$$x_k^{(i)} = p(x_k | x_{k-1}^{(i)}, u_{k-1}) \quad i = 1, \dots, N \quad (2.21)$$

2. Update weights from the measurement

$$\begin{aligned} w_k^{*(i)} &\propto p(y_k \mid x_k^{(i)}) \quad i = 1, \dots, N \\ w_k^{(i)} &= \frac{w_k^{*(i)}}{\sum_{j=1}^N w_k^{*(j)}} \quad i = 1, \dots, N \end{aligned} \quad (2.22)$$

3. Resample particles from a distribution proportional to the weights.

2.2 Related Work

As previously mentioned, the whole-body insulin sensitivity S_I dynamically fluctuates over time depending on the patient's metabolic condition. As a result, naively assigning S_I as a constant parameter can hinder the performance of the estimators. A nonlinear and nonconvex integral-based parameter identification method has been introduced that can approximate patient-specific parameters [15]. By linearly interpolating between the blood glucose measurements in times $[t_0, t_1]$,

$$\widetilde{G}(t) = \frac{G(t_1) - G(t_0)}{t_1 - t_0} t, \quad (2.23)$$

the Equation (2.1) can be rearranged as such for a piecewise constant S_I

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \dot{G} \, dt &= -p_G \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) \, dt - S_I \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) \frac{Q(t)}{1 + \alpha_G Q(t)} \, dt \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{V_G} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} P(t) + E_G - C_G \, dt \\ G(t_1) - G(t_0) &= -p_G \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) \, dt - S_I \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) \frac{Q(t)}{1 + \alpha_G Q(t)} \, dt \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{V_G} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} P(t) + E_G - C_G \, dt, \end{aligned} \quad (2.24)$$

and S_I can be expressed as a linear equation

$$\underbrace{\int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) \frac{Q(t)}{1 + \alpha_G Q(t)} dt}_{A(t_0, t_1)} S_I = \underbrace{\left(G(t_0) - G(t_1) - p_G \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \widetilde{G}(t) dt + \frac{1}{V_G} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} (P(t) + E_G - C_G) dt \right)}_{b(t_0, t_1)}. \quad (2.25)$$

It is often the case with longer measurement periods ($t_1 - t_0$), that identifying multiple S_I values within the time period may be necessary. For instance, if every 120 mins glucose measurements are taken from the patient, but every 60 mins a patient's insulin sensitivity should be identified $S_I \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Both insulin sensitivity parameters at 60 mins S_I^{60} and 120 mins S_I^{120} can be derived as the least squares solution from the system of linear equations

$$\begin{bmatrix} A(t_0, t_0 + 30) & 0 \\ A(t_0 + 30, t_0 + 60) & 0 \\ 0 & A(t_0 + 60, t_0 + 90) \\ 0 & A(t_0 + 90, t_0 + 120) \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} S_I^{60} \\ S_I^{120} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} b(t_0, t_0 + 30) \\ b(t_0 + 30, t_0 + 60) \\ b(t_0 + 60, t_0 + 90) \\ b(t_0 + 90, t_0 + 120) \end{bmatrix}. \quad (2.26)$$

The fundamental flaw of the integral-based parameter identification method is the assumption of linear blood glucose dynamics between measurements of times $[t_0, t_1]$. If we closely analyze the Figure 2.1, linearly interpolating blood glucose introduces residuals, due to fitting errors. Consequently, the residuals will propagate into the integrals in the Equation (2.25), resulting in errors in the parameter calculation. Relying on data-driven methods can not account for physiological behavior in the parameters, and other methods must be explored to allow for realistic estimation of parameters, thus giving better insight of the patient's health status to clinicians.

*The initial conditions of the patient model are $BG = 5.0$ (mmol/L), $I = 15.0$ (mU/L), $Q = 15.0$ (mU/L), $P1 = P2 = 0.0$ (mmol). The inputs are $u_{ex}(t) = 75 \cdot e^{-\left(\frac{\log(2)}{300}\right) \cdot ((t+120) \bmod (300))}$ (mU/min), $P_N(t) = e^{-\left(\frac{\log(2)}{300}\right) \cdot (t \bmod (300))}$ (mmol/min), and no external nutrition is given. Measurements are sampled with additive Gaussian noise $r_k \sim N(0, 0.25^2)$.

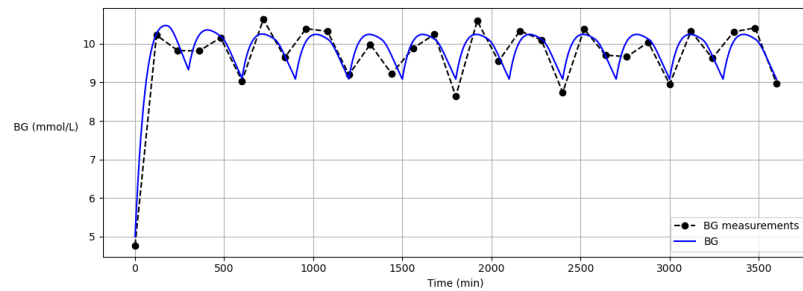


Figure 2.1: Blood glucose and its' corresponding measurements from the patient model*.

2.3 Summary

The Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose model provides a foundation to model glucose removal, insulin pharmacokinetics, and gastric absorption of glucose for tight glucose control in critically ill patients. Often, clinicians solely rely on blood glucose measurements, which limits the knowledge of the insulin-glucose dynamics in real-time. Utilizing nonlinear state estimators, such as the extended Kalman filter and the bootstrap particle filter, allow for estimation of all dynamics over time. To evaluate patient-specific parameters, model identifiability is used to make inferences about the parameters of interest. The current method of integral-based parameter identification is formulated with strict assumptions of blood glucose measurements, which limits the ability for clinicians to infer the health of the patient from the approximated patient-specific parameters. More in-depth methods can improve model identifiability for glucoregulation in critically ill patients.

Chapter 3

Research Methods

This chapter will consist of presenting the scientific design of the experiment. Beginning with the overall goals of the study, and how the corresponding experimental process will be formulated to achieve answering the stated research questions. The inclusion and motivation of the data collected, models used, and analysis of the observations in the experiment will be laid out in the following sections.

3.1 Research Process

The main topics this study aim to address fall in line with the following research questions:

1. **Does the mathematical formulation of the Intensive Control Insulin-Nutrition-Glucose model permit patient-specific model-identifiability when approximating insulin-glucose dynamics for patients in the intensive care unit?**
2. **How do state estimation techniques compare against traditional parameter-identification methods in estimating patient-specific insulin-glucose dynamics in terms of accuracy and computational complexity?**

Given the overall experimental goals, the research process can therefore be outlined as such:

Step 1 create virtual patients,

Step 2 conduct experiments with patient data,

Step 3 analyze statistical metrics from the experiments, and

Step 4 discuss the results of the analysis.

3.2 Research Paradigm

The philosophical motivation in this study is founded on utilizing a set of quantitative methods that serve the purpose of ultimately answering the previously stated research questions. The use of statistical metrics will quantitatively express the relationships of variables tested in the experiment. Consequently, the research questions will effectively be addressed.

3.3 Data Collection

A virtual patient cohort will be simulated to model clinical insulin-glucose data observed in patients in the intensive care unit. A patient model consists of simulated insulin-glucose dynamics ($G, Q, I, P1, P2$) represented in Equations (2.1) to (2.5), known insulin sensitivity $S_I(t)$, exogenous insulin $u_{ex}(t)$, and enteral feed $D(t)$. The population constants listed in Table 2.1 are assigned to the constant parameters for all virtual patients. To simulate patient data, each virtual patient (100 total patients) is given an initial state for the dynamics x_0 . Blood glucose concentration (mmol/L) has been demonstrated to have an underlying log-normal distribution [20], thus, for the purpose of this experiment, we can define blood glucose as the following random variable $\ln G \sim N(2.02, 1.3^2)$, with each patient being assigned an unique initial state of

$$\begin{aligned} x_0 &= [G_0 \quad Q_0 \quad I_0 \quad P1_0 \quad P2_0] \\ &= [\exp(\ln G) \quad 15.0 \quad 15.0 \quad 0.0 \quad 0.0]. \end{aligned} \quad (3.1)$$

Q_0 and I_0 are both chosen as 16.5 (mU/L) as the initial interstitial and plasma insulin concentration are in line with measurements collected to model an insulin-glucose system [21]. The initial glucose concentration (mmol/L) in the stomach $P1_0$ and gut $P2_0$ are assumed to be zero at the beginning of insulin infusion and feeding. All patients are given continuous ($t = \text{mins}$) exogenous insulin input

$$u_{ex}(t) = 140 \exp\left(-\frac{\log 2}{300}(t \bmod 300)\right) \text{ (mU/min)}, \quad (3.2)$$

and a constant enternal intake of glucose

$$D(t) = 0.30 \text{ (mmol/min)}. \quad (3.3)$$

The units of insulin per hour (U/hr) can be derived as

$$\frac{1}{1000} \int_{t_1}^{t_1+60} u_{ex}(t) dt \approx 7.84 \text{ (U/hr)} \quad \text{for } t > 300, \quad (3.4)$$

as well as the total caloric intake of glucose per day

$$\frac{0.30 \text{ (mol/min)}}{1000} \times 180.156 \text{ (g/mol)} \times 1440 \text{ (min)} \times 4 \text{ (kcal/day)} \approx 304 \text{ (kcal/day)}, \quad (3.5)$$

with both aligning in typical ranges given to ICU patients in the Karolinska University Hospital.

Given all the initial states x_0 , known insulin sensitivity $S_I(t)$, and the patient inputs $u_{ex}(t)$, $D(t)$, the patient cohort can be generated by solving the Differential Equations (2.1) to (2.5) from times 0 mins to 3600 mins with a time step of $dt = 1$ min for each patient. The ODE solver `scipy.integrate.solve_ivp`* function in python will be applied with the Explicit Runge-Kutta of order 5(4) integration method [22] to solve for the necessary dynamics.

3.4 Assessing reliability and validity of the data collected

A virtual patient cohort is a simplified model to characterize the target population of patients in the intensive care unit, given certain assumptions of the patients. Each patient will have their unique insulin-glucose model that contains all the recorded dynamics and inputs in time.

3.4.1 Validity of method

The patient models, parameters, and initial states are all adopted and cross-validated from multiple clinically validated studies. This provides a physiologically accurate basis to the control variables of the experiment.

*https://docs.scipy.org/doc/scipy/reference/generated/scipy.integrate.solve_ivp.html

Interventions in the experiment can be assessed and compared knowing the manipulated variable is correlated with the change in the output and not due to poor model formulation.

3.4.2 Reliability of method

Simulating patient data gives the necessary control to assign all patient parameters. A clear benefit of virtual patients is the repeatability of experiments, given identical patient parameters. Often in clinical settings, the true patient dynamics and parameters are unknown. Thus, results from clinical data may not be repeatable under the same conditions as there could be unaccounted for variables in the methods.

3.5 Planned Data Analysis

3.6 Evaluation framework

Chapter 4

Research Methodology

4.1 Patient Identifiability

4.1.1 Observability

4.1.2 Integral-Based Fitting

4.2 Nonlinear State Estimation

4.3 Parameter Estimation

Chapter 5

Results and Analysis

5.1 Major results

Theorem 1. *Given a blood glucose measurement, there exists a nonunique solution for the unknown insulin sensitivity S_I and the interstitial glucose concentration Q .*

Proof. Let y be a positive blood glucose measurement corrupted with zero-mean Gaussian measurement noise of variance σ^2 , and $f(S_I, Q)$ denotes the true blood glucose in terms of the corresponding insulin sensitivity and interstitial glucose concentration from the ODE in Equation (2.1). Under the Maximum Likelihood Expectation criterion for a Gaussian process, the most probable S_I and Q given the observation is the maximum of the log-likelihood

$$\begin{aligned}
 P(S_I, Q | y) &= \frac{P(y | S_I, Q)P(S_I, Q)}{P(y)} \\
 &= \frac{P(y | S_I, Q)P(S_I)P(Q)}{P(y)} \\
 S_I^*, Q^* &= \arg \max_{S_I, Q} \ln P(y | S_I, Q) \\
 &= \arg \max_{S_I, Q} \ln \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(y - f(S_I, Q))^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \right) \\
 &= \arg \max_{S_I, Q} -\frac{1}{2} \ln(2\pi\sigma^2) - \frac{(y - f(S_I, Q))^2}{2\sigma^2},
 \end{aligned} \tag{5.1}$$

which yields the pair (S_I^*, Q^*) such that $f(S_I^*, Q^*) = y$.

Let H_0 and H_1 denote the null and alternative hypotheses, respectively.

- H_0 : Given the measurement y , the pair (S_I^*, Q^*) is the unique solution for S_I and Q of Equation (2.1)
- H_1 : Given the same measurement y , there exists nonzero perturbations (δ_S, δ_Q) such that $(S_I^* + \delta_S, Q^* + \delta_Q)$ satisfies Equation (2.1), so that the solution is nonunique.

For H_0 to be true, if δ_Q is nonzero, there should be no δ_S that satisfies the given equation

$$(S_I^* + \delta_S)y \frac{(Q^* + \delta_Q)}{1 + \alpha_G(Q^* + \delta_Q)} - S_I^*y \frac{Q^*}{1 + \alpha_G Q^*} = 0 \quad \text{for } \delta_Q \neq -\frac{1}{\alpha_G} - Q^*, \quad (5.2)$$

as that would imply S_I^* is dependent on Q^* . If one continues to solve for Equation (5.2), you would arrive at the following result

$$\delta_S = \frac{S_I^* Q^* (1 + \alpha_G(Q^* + \delta_Q))}{(Q^* + \delta_Q)(1 + \alpha_G Q^*)} - S_I^* \quad \text{for } \delta_Q \notin \left\{-\frac{1}{\alpha_G} - Q^*, -Q^*\right\}. \quad (5.3)$$

Thus, given a nonzero δ_Q , there exists a corresponding δ_S , which would result in rejecting the hypothesis H_0 . $\square$

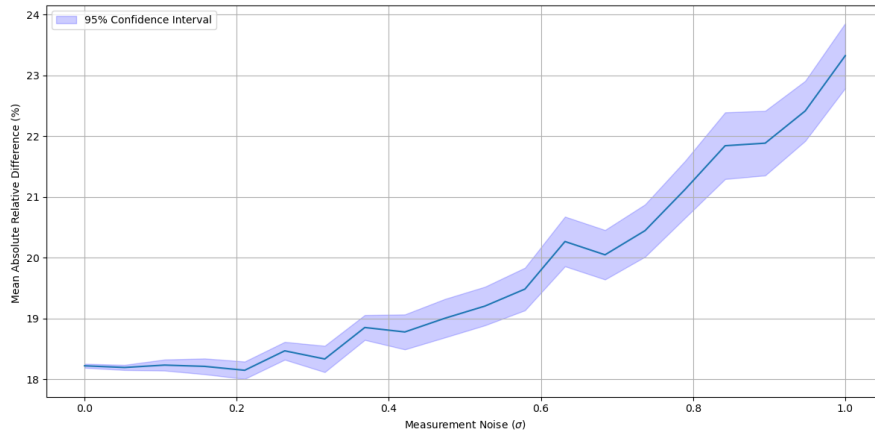


Figure 5.1: The performance of approximating insulin sensitivity with the integral-based method across various measurement noise.

Table 5.1: Comparing different estimators based on their respective time complexity and prediction performance regarding blood glucose.

Estimator	Median (Run Time, s)	IQR (Run Time, s)	Median (MSE)	IQR (MSE)
EKF	0.3252	0.0092	0.3998	0.0356
PF ($N = 500$)	129.1	1.686	0.3991	0.0400
PF ($N = 750$)	193.6	1.870	0.3954	0.0364
PF ($N = 1000$)	257.8	2.067	0.3962	0.0384
PF ($N = 1250$)	323.1	2.895	0.3962	0.0363

The extended Kalman Filter is denoted as EKF, with PF representing the particle filter with N total particles.

5.2 Reliability Analysis

Analys av tillförlitlighet
Tillförlitlighet i metod och data

5.3 Validity Analysis

Analys av validitet
Validitet i metod och data

Chapter 6

Discussion

Chapter 7

Conclusions and Future work

Slutsats och framtida arbete

Add text to introduce the subsections of this chapter.

7.1 Conclusions

Slutsatser

Describe the conclusions (reflect on the whole introduction given in Chapter 1).

Discuss the positive effects and the drawbacks.

Describe the evaluation of the results of the degree project.

Did you meet your goals?

What insights have you gained?

What suggestions can you give to others working in this area?

If you had it to do again, what would you have done differently?

Uppfyllde du dina mål?

Vilka insikter har du fått?

Vilka förslag kan du ge till andra som arbetar inom detta område? Om du skulle göra detta igen, vad skulle du ha gjort annorlunda?

7.2 Limitations

Begränsande faktorer

Vad gjorde du som begränsade dina ansträngningar? Vilka är begränsningarna i dina resultat?

What did you find that limited your efforts? What are the limitations of your results?

7.3 Future work

Vad du har kvar ogjort?

Vad är nästa självklara saker som ska göras?

Vad tips kan du ge till nästa person som kommer att följa upp på ditt arbete?

Describe valid future work that you or someone else could or should do. Consider: What you have left undone? What are the next obvious things to be done? What hints can you give to the next person who is going to follow up on your work?

Due to the breadth of the problem, only some of the initial goals have been met. In these section we will focus on some of the remaining issues that should be addressed in future work. ...

7.3.1 What has been left undone?

The prototype does not address the third requirement, *i.e.*, a yearly unavailability of less than 3 minutes, this remains an open problem. ...

7.3.1.1 Cost analysis

Example of a missing component

The current prototype works, but the performance from a cost perspective makes this an impractical solution. Future work must reduce the cost of this solution, to do so a cost analysis needs to first be done. ...

7.3.1.2 Security

Example of a missing component

A future research effort is needed to address the security holes that results from using a self-signed certificate. Page filling text mass. Page filling text mass. ...

7.3.2 Next obvious things to be done

In particular, the author of this thesis wishes to point out xxxxxx remains as a problem to be solved. Solving this problem is the next thing that should be done. ...

7.4 Reflections

Reflektioner

Vilka är de relevanta ekonomiska, sociala, miljömässiga och etiska aspekter av ditt arbete?

What are the relevant economic, social, environmental, and ethical aspects of your work?

One of the most important results is the reduction in the amount of energy required to process each packet while at the same time reducing the time required to process each packet.

The thesis contributes to the **United Nations (UN) Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** numbers 1 and 9 by xxxx.

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Appendix A

Something Extra

svensk: Extra Material som Bilaga

A.1 Just for testing KTH colors

You have selected to optimize for print output

- Primary color

- kth-blue 

- kth-blue80 

- Secondary colors

- kth-lightblue 

- kth-lightred 

- kth-lightred80 

- kth-lightgreen 

- kth-coolgray 

- kth-coolgray80 

black 

Appendix B

Main equations

This appendix gives some examples of equations that are used throughout this thesis.

B.1 A simple example

The following example is adapted from Figure 1 of the documentation for the package `nomencl` (<https://ctan.org/pkg/nomencl>).

$$a = \frac{N}{A} \tag{B.1}$$

The equation $\sigma = ma$ follows easily from Equation (B.1).

B.2 An even simpler example

The formula for the diameter of a circle is shown in Equation (B.2) area of a circle is shown in eq. (B.3).

$$D_{circle} = 2\pi r \tag{B.2}$$

$$A_{circle} = \pi r^2 \tag{B.3}$$

Some more text that refers to (B.3).

€€€€ For DIVA €€€€

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    , "City": "Stockholm" },
    "Number of lang instances": "2",
    "Abstract[eng ]": €€€€
  }
```

Enter your abstract here!

Write an abstract that is about 250 and 350 words (1/2 A4-page) with the following components:

- What is the topic area? (optional) Introduces the subject area for the project.
- Short problem statement
- Why was this problem worth a Bachelor's/Master's thesis project? (*i.e.*, why is the problem both significant and of a suitable degree of difficulty for a Bachelor's/Master's thesis project? Why has no one else solved it yet?)
- How did you solve the problem? What was your method/insight?
- Results/Conclusions/Consequences/Impact: What are your key results/ conclusions? What will others do based upon your results? What can be done now that you have finished - that could not be done before your thesis project was completed?

€€€€,

"Keywords[eng]": €€€€

Canvas Learning Management System, Docker containers, Performance tuning €€€€,

"Abstract[swe]": €€€€

Enter your Swedish abstract or summary here!

Alla avhandlingar vid KTH **måste ha** ett abstrakt på både *engelska* och *svenska*.
Om du skriver din avhandling på svenska ska detta göras först (och placera det som det första abstraktet) - och du bör revidera det vid behov.

If you are writing your thesis in English, you can leave this until the draft version that goes to your opponent for the written opposition. In this way you can provide the English and Swedish abstract/summary information that can be used in the announcement for your oral presentation. If you are writing your thesis in English, then this section can be a summary targeted at a more general reader. However, if you are writing your thesis in Swedish, then the reverse is true – your abstract should be for your target audience, while an English summary can be written targeted at a more general audience.
This means that the English abstract and Swedish sammanfattning or Swedish abstract and English summary need not be literal translations of each other.

Do not use the `\glspl{}` command in an abstract that is not in English, as my programs do not know how to generate plurals in other languages. Instead you will need to spell these terms out or give the proper plural form. In fact, it is a good idea not to use the glossary commands at all in an abstract/summary in a language other than the language used in the `acronyms.tex` file - since the glossary package does **not** support use of more than one language.

The abstract in the language used for the thesis should be the first abstract, while the Summary/Sammanfattning in the other language can follow

```
€€€€,
"Keywords[swe ]": €€€€
Canvas Lärplattform, Dockerbehållare, Prestandajustering €€€€,
}
```

acronyms.tex

```
%%% Local Variables:
%%% mode: latex
%%% TeX-master: t
%%% End:
% The following command is used with glossaries-extra
\setabbreviationstyle{acronym}{long-short}
% The form of the entries in this file is \newacronym{label}{acronym}{phrase}
%                                     or \newacronym[options]{label}{acronym}{phrase}
% see "User Manual for glossaries.sty" for the details about the options, one example is shown below
% note the specification of the long form plural in the line below
\newacronym[longplural={Debugging Information Entities}]{DIE}{DIE}{Debugging Information Entity}
%
% The following example also uses options
\newacronym[shortplural={OSes}, firstplural={operating systems (OSes)}]{OS}{OS}{operating system}

% note the use of a non-breaking dash in long text for the following acronym
\newacronym{IQL}{IQL}{Independent Q-Learning} % <-- regular dash

\newacronym{KTH}{KTH}{KTH Royal Institute of Technology}

\newacronym{LAN}{LAN}{Local Area Network}
\newacronym{VM}{VM}{virtual machine}
% note the use of a non-breaking dash in the following acronym
\newacronym{WiFi}{Wi-Fi}{Wireless Fidelity}

\newacronym{WLAN}{WLAN}{Wireless Local Area Network}
\newacronym{UN}{UN}{United Nations}
\newacronym{SDG}{SDG}{Sustainable Development Goal}
```